



Hydrogen-powered train

The Hydroflex, a hydrogen-powered train, made its maiden 25-mile round-trip in Warwickshire. <http://digit.in/oct20-87>



125W fast charger coming soon?

A 125 W fast charger by Realme has been teased on Twitter by company CEO Madhav Sheth. <http://digit.in/oct20-88>

Fictional supercomputers

If only we could benchmark these

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DEEP THOUGHT

Deep Thought is the computer from Douglas Adams' *Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy* series, where it was tasked to come up with the Answer to Life, the Universe, and Everything, also known as the ultimate question. After thinking for 7.5 million years, Deep Thought says the



answer is 42, but the programmers are not satisfied, and Deep Thought says it is because they do not understand the question. Deep Thought then designs a superior computer, Earth, to find out what the question is. In fact, researchers from IBM and Carnegie Mellon actually developed a supercomputer called Deep

Thought, the first machine to defeat a chess grandmaster in 1988.



GLADOS

In *Portal*, Genetic Lifeform and Disk Operating System is the computer at Aperture Science that likes making test subjects go through escape room games, and is a ruthless killer. The designer of the computer used a surprisingly regular approach in fiction to provide the intelligence, by uploading the brain of his real life assistant, Caroline into what was otherwise a conventional computing system. GLaDOS has a high opinion of herself, and attempts to constantly trigger the protagonist through a series of mischievous microaggressions. The protagonist of the game is forced to dismantle and neutralise the computer, but GLaDOS is still alive.

HAL 9000

The on board computer of the *Discovery One* spacecraft in 2001: A Space

Odyssey, Heuristically programmed ALgorithmic Computer 9000 is a computer that inspired a whole generation of fictional computers, including GERTY in *Moon* and TARS in *Interstellar*. No matter how grave the situation, HAL always responds in a calm, deadpan tone. HAL has been programmed through a series of activities including playing chess and listening to stories, that were designed as an accelerated



form of the schooling imparted to a human child. Frank Poole and David Bowman might have skipped portions of the owner's manual as they are unaware that HAL is capable of face recognition, lip reading and understanding human emotions.

HELIOS

In *Deus Ex*, Helios is the combined form of two computers, Daedalus and Icarus. While Daedalus is benign and beneficial, while Icarus is just plain evil. The architecture of the computer is interesting, as it does not exist in a single location or server farm, but is instead distributed as snippets of code across all the computers in the world. It is both a form of distributed computing and a sentient botnet. While Daedalus was simply meant to be an agent to process and monitor vast troves of information, it became self aware. JC Denton merges Daedalus and Icarus into a single entity, Helios, which then attempts to save

